

Managing Phases in Lifecycles

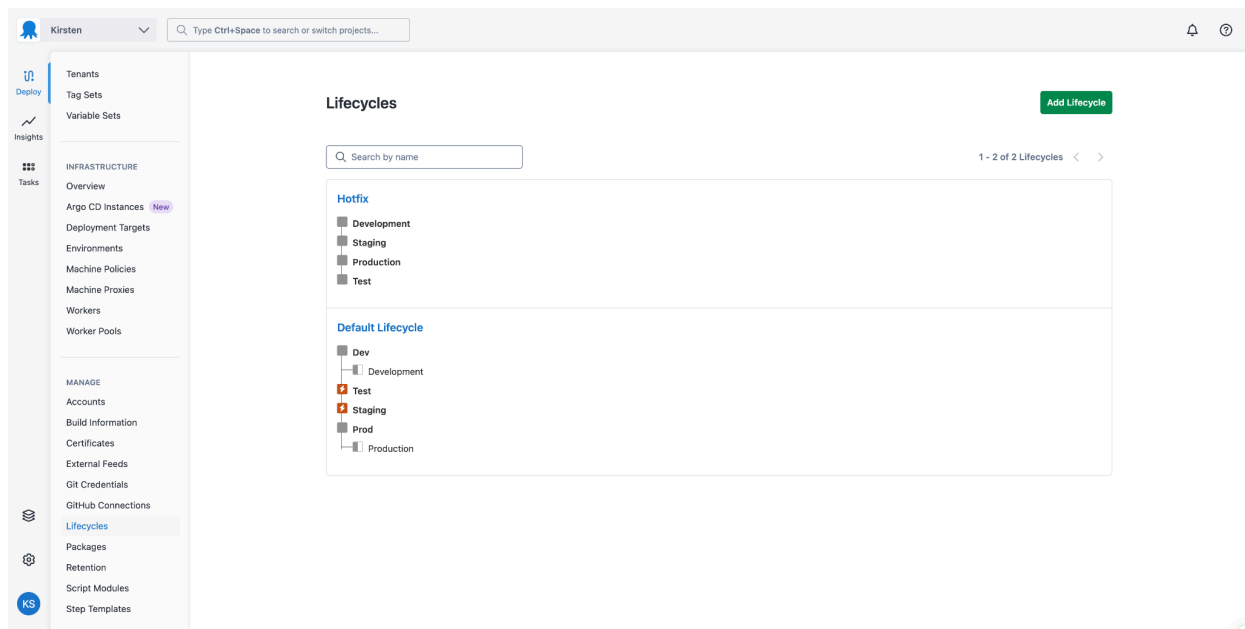
Background

Lifecycles define how releases can be promoted between environments. They control which environments releases are deployed to, in what order and whether deployments happen automatically for a certain phase. You can have different lifecycles for different scenarios e.g. standard and hotfix.

Octopus automatically creates a default lifecycle for you that contains a phase for each environment. When you deploy your release, it passes through the phases of the lifecycle in order.

The lifecycle preview gives a visual representation of the phases, environments and whether the deployments are automated. The preview is also used in other places across Octopus, for example:

- New project creation
- Next to the deployment process
- Trigger configuration



Kirsten

Type Ctrl+Space to search or switch projects...

Deploy

Tenants

Tag Sets

Variable Sets

Insights

Tasks

INFRASTRUCTURE

Overview

Argo CD Instances **New**

Deployment Targets

Environments

Machine Policies

Machine Proxies

Workers

Worker Pools

MANAGE

Accounts

Build Information

Certificates

External Feeds

Git Credentials

GitHub Connections

Lifecycles

Packages

Retention

Script Modules

Step Templates

Lifecycles

Create Lifecycle **Save**

Phases

Projects that use this lifecycle can only be deployed according to the phases below. **Add Phase**

Phase 1 Please enter phase details

Phase name

Environments

Any environment

When the release is in this phase, any environment can be deployed to. Use the **Add environment** button to limit the phase to a specific list of environments. **Add Environment**

Required to progress

☒ All must complete (default)

☐ A minimum of 0 must complete

☐ Optional phase

Retention policy (inherited)

Releases: Use default policy. Files on Tentacle: Use default policy. **Override retention policy**

Phase priority

Priority is available on the Enterprise tier. [Request a free trial](#)

☐ Prioritize this phase

Add Environment

Environment

Development

☒ Deploy **automatically** to this environment as soon as the release enters this phase.

☐ Users will need to **manually** queue the deployment to this environment. (default)

Cancel **Ok**

What users need to do:

- Create new lifecycle phases
- Add environments to phases
- Set automated or manual deployment per environment
- Set rules per phase
- Reorder phases
- Override retention policies per phase
- Set deployment priority
- Preview lifecycle

Problem Statement

The current lifecycle phases interface hasn't been updated in many years and doesn't follow current UX best practices. The lifecycle preview no longer reflects the Octopus design language and only uses icons to distinguish between automated and manual deployments.

Objectives

- Improve the overall experience when configuring lifecycle phases
- Help users build a mental model of lifecycles and environments
- Improve microcopy to aid comprehension
- Make the lifecycle preview more visually appealing and understandable

Scope

What's in scope

- Lifecycles list page
- Lifecycle phases
- Lifecycle preview

What's out of scope

- Name field
- Description field
- Retention policy field
- Phase priority

Follow-on tasks

After redesigning the lifecycle phases UI, here are a few additional tasks to round off the project:

1. Component contribution

Work with the Frontend Foundations team to contribute the updated Lifecycle Preview component to the design system.

2. Promote triggers

Consider how to introduce users to Triggers from the lifecycles page if they have any automated deployments configured. This will allow them to do automatic pull-based deployments.

3. Usability study

Conduct an internal usability study to test the new lifecycle phases interface with at least 5 Octonauts.

Resources

- [Lifecycles demo video](#)
- [Lifecycles documentation](#)
- [Triggers demo video](#)